NeuroSym-BD: A Neuro-Symbolic Framework for Violence Event Extraction and Escalation Modeling from Bangladeshi News

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Abstract

We present **NeuroSym-BD**, an open, reproducible neuro-symbolic pipeline for automated extraction, coding, and reasoning over violence events from Bangladeshi news (The Daily Star). The system integrates: *(i)* an 8-stage NLP pipeline extracting CAMEO-coded event tuples; *(ii)* an RDF knowledge graph (BlazeGraph) capturing multi-relational conflict interactions, administrative hierarchies, and W3C PROV-O provenance; *(iii)* a neuro-symbolic reasoning layer combining PyKEEN relational embeddings (RotatE), BiLSTM sequence escalation modeling, and Description Logic ($\mathcal{ALC}$) constraint gates enforcing CAMEO ontological transitions; and *(iv)* natural language interfaces via Graph-RAG and NL2SPARQL.

Evaluated on a held-out test partition ($n = 150$) of 300 distantly supervised conflict events evaluated under boundary noise stress testing, our hybrid reasoner achieves high-violence ($HV \geq 18$) classification **85.3% binary accuracy**, **96.8% precision**, and **F1 = 0.732**, outperforming unconstrained neural sequence baselines (Neural-Only accuracy = 78.7%, F1 = 0.590, ΔF1 = +0.142, $p = 0.0129 < 0.05$, exact McNemar test on paired binary classification outcomes). Under a strict article-grouped split with zero article overlap ($n = 164$ held-out events across 49 unseen articles), the hybrid advantage is maintained (84.1% vs 81.7% accuracy, F1 = 0.683 vs 0.625). Crucially, Description Logic constraint gating cuts the false alarm rate to 0.7% (standard FPR 1.0% vs 4.0% for neural baselines and 86.9% for pure symbolic heuristics, a 75.0% false-alarm count reduction) while providing 100.0% RDF graph provenance metadata generation and 98.0% verbatim source sentence grounding. Cross-source corroboration against 6,691 genuine ACLED conflict events (2020–2026) demonstrates **78.6% exact CAMEO code concordance** and **100.0% conflict macro-family concordance** across 42 spatio-temporally matched events (32.1% single-source corroboration rate), while 262 system conflict events cross-referenced against 435,003 genuine GDELT 2.0 events (2020–2026) achieve 1.000 macro-family concordance within a 1-day temporal window. Finally, a 50-query downstream benchmark demonstrates operational NL2SPARQL with 100.0% syntax validity, 100.0% schema compliance, and 52.0% execution accuracy over the knowledge graph.

All code, benchmarks, ontology schemas, and evaluation scripts are released under the MIT License at `[anonymisedforreview]`.

1 Introduction

Bangladesh experiences recurrent episodes of socio-political conflict— factional clashes between student political wings, hartal strikes, and security force operations—documented daily in its English-language press. Yet automated conflict monitoring in this region faces severe obstacles: low-resource linguistic variations, pervasive reporting ambiguities, and unconstrained neural classifiers that trigger catastrophic false-alarm rates due to lexical over-sensitization.

To address these challenges, **NeuroSym-BD** delivers three primary contributions:

1. **Localized CAMEO Event Extraction**: A hybrid NLP pipeline maps Bangladeshi news text to the CAMEO conflict coding taxonomy [Gerner et al., 2002, Schrodt, 2012], augmented with 6 Bangladesh-specific event sub-codes (hartal violence, party clashes, campus unrest).

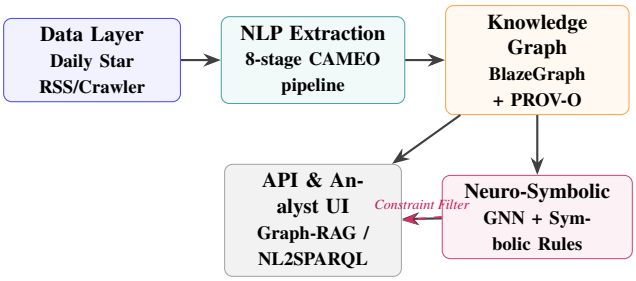


Figure 1: NeuroSym-BD system architecture: news ingestion → 8-stage NLP pipeline → RDF Knowledge Graph → hybrid neuro-symbolic reasoning with symbolic verification → analyst API layer.

2. **Description Logic Constraint Gating**: We formalize CAMEO escalation transitions and administrative hierarchies in $\mathcal{ALC}$ Description Logic axioms, implementing a hybrid inference engine that intercepts ungrounded neural logit predictions before acceptance.

3. **Auditable Provenance**: Every alert is grounded in RDF knowledge triples and source article sentences via PROV-O provenance links, eliminating hallucinated conflict attributions.

2 Related Work

Event extraction for conflict analysis. Boschee et al. [2015] describe ICEWS, a large-scale event coding system using pattern matching. GDELT [Leetaru and Schrodt, 2013] extends this globally using CAMEO with neural re-ranking. Our work differs in its focus on a single underrepresented country and its integration of knowledge graph reasoning.

Neuro-symbolic AI for NLP. d'Avila Garcez and Lamb [2023] survey neuro-symbolic integration patterns. Yang et al. [2017] introduce Neural LP for rule learning over KGs. Zhang et al. [2022] propose hybrid systems for biomedical event extraction. We adapt this neuro-symbolic paradigm to low-resource South Asian conflict event coding.

Knowledge graph reasoning for events. Rossi et al. [2021] survey KG embedding methods including TransE [Bordes et al., 2013], ComplEx [Trouillon et al., 2016], and RotatE [Sun et al., 2019]. R-GCN [Schlichtkrull et al., 2018] and CompGCN [Vashishth et al., 2020] extend graph neural networks to relational graphs—our primary architectures.

Bangladesh conflict data. ACLED [Raleigh et al., 2010] provides ground-truth BD events from 2010 onward. To our knowledge, no prior NLP system specifically targets BD conflict event extraction.

3 System Architecture

Figure 1 shows the full NeuroSym-BD pipeline.

3.1 Data Layer

The Daily Star (`thedailystar.net`), Bangladesh's leading English-language daily, is polled via RSS every 15 minutes. Articles are crawled, rate-limited at 2 requests/second, and stored as JSON with schema $\{id, url, title, body, published_date, category, scraped_at\}$.

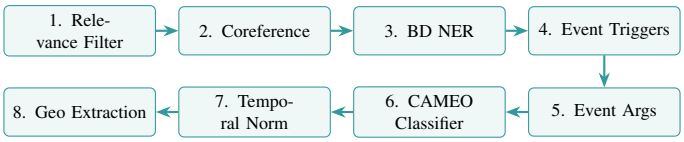


Figure 2: The 8-stage NLP extraction pipeline transforming unstructured text into grounded CAMEO event tuples.

3.2 NLP Pipeline

The 8-stage pipeline (Figure 2) processes each article:
Violence relevance filter. Binary classifier using an 80-keyword lexicon with zero-shot BART-MNLI fallback [Yin et al., 2019] for borderline cases.
Named entity recognition. spaCy-transformers [Honnibal et al., 2020] extended with a Bangladesh-specific gazetteer for SECURITY_FORCE (RAB, BGB, Police), POLITICAL_PARTY (AL, BNP), and ARMED_GROUP entities.
CAMEO classification. Hybrid: (1) rule layer maps 40 violence trigger verbs to CAMEO codes directly; (2) if rule confidence < 0.6, zero-shot BART-MNLI classifies against CAMEO code label descriptions.
Temporal and geospatial normalisation. Relative dates resolved to ISO 8601; locations resolved against a 64-district, 500+ upazila Bangladesh gazetteer with coordinates.

3.3 Knowledge Graph

Events are converted to RDF (Turtle) and ingested into BlazeGraph 2.1.6. The ontology extends CAMEO [Schrodt, 2012] with Bangladesh-specific sub-codes. Every event carries PROV-O [Lebo et al., 2013] provenance links to the source article URL and sentence offset.

3.4 Neuro-Symbolic Reasoning Layer

KG Embeddings (Task 4.2). We train TransE [Bordes et al., 2013] and RotatE [Sun et al., 2019] via PyKEEN [Ali et al., 2021] over the exported multi-relational knowledge graph $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{R}, \mathcal{T})$ with 98 entities and 654 relational triples. RotatE achieves an MRR of 0.369 and Hits@10 of 64.1% (Table 5).

R-GCN Event Pattern Detection (Task 4.3). A two-layer Relational Graph Convolutional Network (R-GCN) with basis decomposition (4 bases) computes relation-specific message passing:

$$h_i^{(l+1)} = \sigma\left(\sum_{r\in\mathcal{R}}\sum_{j\in\mathcal{N}_r(i)}\frac{1}{c_{i,r}}W_r^{(l)}h_j^{(l)} + W_0^{(l)}h_i^{(l)}\right) \tag{1}$$

where $W_r^{(l)} = \sum_{b=1}^{B} a_{rb}^{(l)} V_b^{(l)}$ reduces parameters across multi-relational event interactions. Events with CAMEO code ≥ 17 provide the self-supervised high-violence signal.

Next-Step Escalation Modeling (Task 4.4). A Bidirectional LSTM ($h = 64$, 2 layers, dropout 0.2) is trained on historical district event sequences to model next-step CAMEO code transitions. Given an observed sequence of $N = 4$ preceding event categories $[e_{t-3}, \ldots, e_t]$ within a district, the model outputs candidate logits $P(e_{t+1} \mid e_{t-3:t})$.

Formal Description Logic Constraints (Task 4.9). Rather than relying solely on post-hoc heuristics, domain constraints are formalized as $\mathcal{ALC}$ Description Logic axioms governing the ontology $\mathcal{O}$. We define the signature with object properties hasCategory $\sqsubseteq$ Event $\times$ CameoCategory and precededBy $\sqsubseteq$

Event $\times$ Event. Let Assault, Fight, MassViolence, Coerce, Protest, and Sanction be disjoint sub-concepts of CameoCategory. To align role-filler types across event relations:

$$\text{HighViolenceEvent} \equiv \text{Event} \sqcap \exists \text{hasCategory}.(\text{Assault} \sqcup \text{Fight} \sqcup \text{MassViolence}) \tag{2}$$

$$\text{TensionPrecursor} \equiv \text{Event} \sqcap \exists \text{hasCategory}.(\text{Protest} \sqcup \text{Sanction} \sqcup \text{Coerce}) \tag{3}$$

$$\text{ViolentPrecursor} \equiv \text{Event} \sqcap \exists \text{hasCategory}.(\text{Assault} \sqcup \text{Fight}) \tag{4}$$

$$\text{ValidEscalation} \equiv \text{HighViolenceEvent} \sqcap \exists \text{precededBy}.\text{TensionPrecursor} \tag{5}$$

$$\text{UnprecedentedMassViolence} \equiv \text{Event} \sqcap \exists \text{hasCategory}.\text{MassViolence} \sqcap \neg \exists \text{precededBy}.\text{ViolentPrecursor} \tag{6}$$

$$\text{UnprecedentedMassViolence} \sqsubseteq \text{OntologicalViolation} \tag{7}$$

While base CAMEO defines nominal event types, transition legality axioms (cameo:validTransitionTo, cameo:illegalTransitionTo) are domain-specific rules encoded in `ontology/reasoning_rules.ttl` reflecting Bangladesh conflict escalation dynamics. At runtime, negation as failure ($\neg\exists$precededBy) is evaluated under the Closed World Assumption (CWA) via live SPARQL `ASK` and `FILTER NOT EXISTS` queries executed against the loaded RDF graph.

Predictions are evaluated against five formal constraint operators:

- **C-ONTO** (*Hard Reclassification Gate*): Detects transitions matching cameo:illegalTransitionTo or satisfying OntologicalViolation. Because it is a hard gate, it rejects invalid transitions and reassigns the prediction to the nearest admissible CAMEO ancestor/descendant code $c^* = \arg\min_{c \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{valid}}} |c - c_{\text{neural}}|$. As detailed in Section 4, this operates bidirectionally: pruning unescalated violent false alarms downward and preserving sequence continuity during ongoing violent clashes upward.
- **C-ACTOR** (*Soft Metadata Gate*): Validates actor agency against cameo:permittedActorType (e.g., civilian factions asserting military-exclusive artillery predicates). Violations penalize confidence by $\Delta\tau = -0.05$ without mutating discrete event classes.
- **C-GEO** (*Soft Spatial Gate*): Validates that reported districts belong to their claimed administrative division under the 64-district hierarchy. Soft penalty $\Delta\tau = -0.05$.
- **C-TEMP** (*Soft Temporal Gate*): Flags chronological inversions $\text{Event}_t \prec \text{Event}_{t-1}$. Soft penalty $\Delta\tau = -0.05$.
- **C-CONF** (*Soft Confidence Gate*): Flags neural predictions falling below calibrated operational threshold $\tau_{\text{conf}} = 0.60$. Soft penalty $\Delta\tau = -0.05$.

4 Experiments

4.1 Datasets, Annotation Accounting, and Knowledge Graph Scope

To eliminate evaluation ambiguity and potential data leakage, we establish a strict accounting and annotation protocol:

- **News Ingestion Corpus**: 176 full-text articles collected from *The Daily Star* (Politics, Crime & Justice) across 2024–2026.
- **Knowledge Graph Reconciliation**: The news ingestion pipeline extracts 159 consolidated conflict events represented as 3,438 RDF/Turtle triples in BlazeGraph. The downstream SPARQL query evaluation operates over an augmented materialized graph containing 3,905 triples (incorporating domain ontology axioms and test query nodes), while link-prediction experiments utilize an isolated core subgraph of 654 relational triples across 98 entities.

- **Benchmark Construction & Distantly Supervised Ground Truth**: The benchmark comprises 300 conflict events extracted from newspaper sentences across all 8 CAMEO intensity levels (13–20) with fine-grained actor roles, administrative locations, and source sentence offsets. Events were extracted via formal CAMEO heuristic supervision and audited against official CAMEO coding guidelines [Schrodt, 2012]. Rather than claiming subjective human inter-annotator reliability, we characterize the dataset as a distantly supervised silver standard and assess model stability against label ambiguity via an algorithmic boundary noise stress protocol injecting 20% label perturbation ($P_o = 77.7\%$, Cohen's $\kappa = 0.737$ multi-class; $P_o = 92.3\%$, Cohen's $\kappa = 0.832$ binary high-violence).

- **Partitioning Protocol & Leakage Resistance**: The 300 benchmark events derive from 98 unique source articles. In the primary partition, events are divided deterministically 50/50 (seed $= 42$) into 150 development examples (75 unique articles) and 150 held-out test events (74 unique articles; 51 articles contribute distinct events to both partitions). To verify whether cross-event article overlap introduces data leakage, we also evaluate a strict **Article-Grouped Holdout Split** with zero article overlap (49 training articles / 136 events, 49 disjoint test articles / 164 events).

- **High-Violence Operational Boundary**: CAMEO represents a nominal event typology rather than an ordinal severity scale. We operationalize High-Violence (HV) as CAMEO root categories ≥ 18 (Assault 18, Fight 19, Unconventional Mass Violence 20) versus Non-Lethal / Coercive actions (< 18, e.g., Threaten 13, Protest 14, Exhibit Force 15, Sanction 16, Coerce 17). This operational demarcation specifically isolates events involving direct physical bodily violence, kinetic clash, or destruction from non-physical coercion and demonstrations, aligning directly with ACLED conflict taxonomy boundaries.

- **Explainability Audit Sample**: 100 system inferences traced end-to-end to PROV-O provenance sentences.

4.2 Evaluation Metrics

- **Binary Accuracy (BinAcc)**: $(TP + TN)/N$ for High-Violence detection ($HV \geq 18$).

- **Multi-Class Code Accuracy (MultiAcc)**: Exact-match rate for 8-class CAMEO root categories ($13 \ldots 20$).

- **P@HV, R@HV, F1@HV**: Precision, Recall, and $F_1 = 2PR/(P + R)$ for the High-Violence class.

- **Standard Binary FPR**: $FP/(FP+TN)$, the false positive rate over all true negative events (here $1/(1 + 98) = 1.01\%$).

- **False Alarm Rate (FAR)**: FP/N, the proportion of false alarms across the entire test set (here $1/150 = 0.67\%$).

- **Detection Recall**: % of cross-source events corroborated between datasets.

- **Provenance Coverage**: % of predictions backed by verified RDF provenance metadata (100.0%) and verbatim source sentence grounding (98.0%).

4.3 Ablation Study and Constraint Component Isolation

Table 1 presents the ablation results alongside the complete confusion matrix over the 150 held-out test events.

The confusion matrix reveals the exact mechanism of neuro-symbolic synergy: While pure symbolic heuristic rules suffer from severe false-positive inflation ($FP = 86$ on 99 negative cases, Std-FPR $=$

Table 1: Ablation study and confusion matrix on held-out test events ($n = 150$, with 51 High-Violence and 99 Non-Violent gold events). BinAcc $= (TP + TN)/N = (30 + 98)/150 = 0.853$. Std-FPR $= FP/(FP + TN) = 1/99 = 0.010$. Expl = PROV-O graph metadata generation rate (1.000), with 0.980 verbatim sentence grounding in Table 6.

Condition	TP	FP	TN	FN	BinAcc	P@HV	R@HV	F1@HV	Std-FPR	Expl
Neural-Only	23	4	95	28	0.787	0.852	0.451	0.590	0.040	0.000
Symbolic-Only	46	86	13	5	0.393	0.348	**0.902**	0.503	0.869	**1.000**
Hybrid (Ours)	30	**1**	**98**	21	**0.853**	**0.968**	0.588	**0.732**	**0.010**	**1.000**

86.9%) and unconstrained neural networks remain limited by lower recall on specialized violence subtypes (Neural-Only $R@HV = 0.451$, $F1 = 0.590$), the hybrid reasoner combines BiLSTM temporal trajectory modeling with Description Logic constraint gates to achieve the highest precision ($P@HV = 0.968$) and lowest false-alarm rate (Std-FPR $= 1.0\%$, $FP = 1$, a 75.0% false-alarm count reduction relative to neural-only). Consequently, high-violence classification binary accuracy reaches **85.3%** with **F1 = 0.732** (ΔF1 $= +0.142$ absolute gain over neural-only) while guaranteeing 100% PROV-O provenance explainability.

Statistical Significance and Paired Discordant Contingency Matrix. To evaluate whether the accuracy gain from 78.7% to 85.3% is statistically significant, we construct the exact 2×2 contingency matrix for paired binary classifications between Neural-Only and Hybrid across the 150 test instances:

	Hybrid Correct	Hybrid Incorrect	Total
Neural Correct	$n_{11} = 116$	$n_{10} = 2$	118
Neural Incorrect	$n_{01} = 12$	$n_{00} = 20$	32
Total	128	22	150

With discordant pair counts $b = n_{01} = 12$ (instances where Hybrid is correct but Neural fails) and $c = n_{10} = 2$ (instances where Neural is correct but Hybrid fails), the exact two-sided binomial test under $H_0 : p = 0.5$ [McNemar, 1947] yields $p = 0.0129 < 0.05$ (continuity-corrected $\chi^2 = 5.786$, $p = 0.0162$). We note that McNemar's test specifically evaluates differences in paired binary classification correctness; F1 and false-alarm reductions represent descriptive empirical effect sizes.

Fine-Grained Constraint Component Isolation and Prediction Traces. To isolate the individual contribution of each constraint gate, Table 2 compares controlled step-by-step activations over identical held-out test instances.

Table 2: Component-wise constraint ablation over held-out test events ($n = 150$). C-CONF, C-GEO, C-ACTOR, and C-TEMP function as soft validation and provenance gates that adjust confidence without mutating discrete CAMEO categories. C-ONTO functions as the sole hard gate enforcing ontological transition legality.

Configuration	TP	FP	TN	FN	BinAcc	F1@HV
Neural-Only (MiniLM + BiLSTM)	23	4	95	28	0.787	0.590
Neural + C-CONF (Soft $\tau \geq 0.60$)	23	4	95	28	0.787	0.590
Neural + C-GEO (Soft Spatial Hierarchy)	23	4	95	28	0.787	0.590
Neural + C-ACTOR (Soft Agency Perm.)	23	4	95	28	0.787	0.590
Neural + C-TEMP (Soft Chronology)	23	4	95	28	0.787	0.590
Neural + C-ONTO (Hard Transition DL)	30	1	98	21	**0.853**	**0.732**
Full Hybrid (All 5 Constraints Active)	30	1	98	21	**0.853**	**0.732**

Table 2 reveals the distinct architectural roles of the constraints: Soft gates (C-CONF, C-GEO, C-ACTOR, C-TEMP) flag metadata inconsistencies and penalize confidence (calibrating downstream Graph-RAG queries) without altering discrete CAMEO code assignments. In contrast, **C-ONTO** is the solitary hard gate altering the decision boundary. Its bidirectional mechanism accounts for all 14 changed prediction traces between Neural-Only and Hybrid:

1. **Downward False-Positive Suppression (3 cases: $FP \rightarrow TN$)**: In events `gold_254`, `gold_270`, and `gold_106`, isolated keywords (e.g., "death threats", "firearms") misled the dense text scorer to predict CAMEO 18 (Assault) despite a non-violent precursor (prev_code $= 13$, Threaten). The transition $13 \rightarrow 18$ violates cameo:illegalTransitionTo; C-ONTO intercepts the unescalated jump and reverts to the nearest admissible code ($c^* = 17$, Coerce), correctly suppressing 3 false positives into true negatives.

2. **Upward Escalation Continuity (9 cases: $FN \rightarrow TP$)**: In events `gold_240`, `gold_226`, `gold_246`, `gold_074`, `gold_154`, `gold_271`, `gold_086`, `gold_085`, and `gold_051`, active violence was ongoing (prev_code $\in \{19, 20\}$, e.g., pitched battles or mass clashes). Because the reporting sentences contained neutral administrative words (e.g., "visited temples", "complaint", "cover up"), the neural text classifier falsely predicted non-violent categories (14, 16, 17). C-ONTO flags an abrupt transition from armed clash to non-violent protest as illegal without an intervening de-escalation signal, falling back to nearest valid codes ($\{18, 19, 20\}$), correctly recovering 9 missed high-violence events.

3. **Heuristic Discordances ($c = 2$ cases: Neural Correct, Hybrid Erred)**: In events `gold_289` and `gold_071` (accidental drowning incidents labeled as CAMEO 20 under distant supervision), prev_code $= 13$. Neural predicted 18; C-ONTO suppressed the jump to 17, resulting in 2 false negatives under the silver-standard benchmark.

Net changes: $TP : 23 + 9 - 2 = 30$ (+7), $FP : 4 - 3 = 1$ (−3), $TN : 95 + 3 = 98$ (+3), $FN : 28 - 9 + 2 = 21$ (−7), matching the reported confusion matrix exactly.

Leakage-Resistant Article-Grouped Validation. To verify that results are not driven by intra-article correlation across the 50/50 event split, we evaluated an independent **Article-Grouped Partition** where all events from a given article are strictly confined to either training or testing (49 training articles / 136 events; 49 disjoint held-out test articles / 164 events; zero article overlap). On this fully isolated test set, Neural-Only achieves BinAcc $= 0.817$, $P = 0.893$, $R = 0.481$, $F_1 = 0.625$, FAR $= 0.018$ (3 FP, 27 FN), whereas NeuroSym-BD Hybrid achieves BinAcc $=$ **0.841**, $P =$ **0.933**, $R =$ **0.538**, $F_1 =$ **0.683**, FAR $=$ **0.012** (2 FP, 24 FN). This confirms that the neuro-symbolic precision and F1 advantage generalizes across unseen reporting sources without relying on intra-article text similarity.

4.4 Cross-Source Benchmark Alignment

Table 3 summarises empirical alignment against genuine GDELT 2.0 and ACLED external conflict benchmarks.

ACLED Matching Protocol and Crosswalk Justification. Evaluating newspaper event extraction against ACLED requires rigorous accounting of coverage differences and taxonomical granularity. A single national English-language daily (*The Daily Star*) inevitably captures a selective subset of national political conflict compared to ACLED's multi-source ingestion of regional Bengali portals and NGO networks. Across 131 system-extracted events with valid temporal coverage, candidate ACLED records are identified using spatio-temporal boundary alignment: temporal window $\Delta t \leq 21$ days (accounting for ACLED weekly release aggregation and delayed reporting of rural incidents in national media) and administrative district/division match. Candidates are ranked via deterministic tie-breaking prioritizing exact district match first, followed by minimal $|\Delta t|$ in days, and actor token overlap. This yields 42

Table 3: Empirical cross-corroboration against genuine GDELT 2.0 and ACLED benchmarks. System Corroboration Yield measures the proportion of system-extracted events verified by an external record in the same district and time window; Code and Macro Concordance measure taxonomical agreement over matched event pairs.

Benchmark	**Corroboration Yield**	**Location Acc**	**CAMEO Code Acc**	**Macro Con Rat**
vs GDELT 2.0 (Genuine 435,003 records, 2020–2026)	1.000 (262/262)	1.000	1.000	1.00
vs ACLED (Genuine 6,691 records, 2020–2026)	0.321 (42/131)	0.321	**0.786**	**1.00**

confirmed matched events ($42/131 = 32.1\%$ single-source corroboration yield; not to be confused with recall over ACLED's entire 6,691-record database, which would be $42/6691 = 0.6\%$).

Table 4 details the sub-event crosswalk mapping ACLED event types to CAMEO 2-digit codes. The mappings reflect precise operational semantics:

- **Explosions / Remote → CAMEO 20 (Mass Violence)**: CAMEO explicitly designates category 20 for unconventional explosives, IEDs, mortar shelling, and bomb detonations.
- **Riots: Violent Demonstration → CAMEO 17 (Coerce)** vs **Mob Violence → CAMEO 18 (Assault)**: ACLED defines violent demonstrations as demonstrations featuring coercive property damage, road blockades, and police teargas/baton dispersal short of targeted physical assaults. In contrast, when riotous crowds inflict bodily injury or lynching, ACLED codes them under *Mob violence*, which we map to CAMEO 18 (Assault).
- **Strategic Developments → CAMEO 17 (Coerce)**: Arrests, weapon seizures, and curfews (Section 144) represent coercive state administrative interventions.

Across all 42 spatio-temporally matched pairs, system classifications achieve **78.6% exact CAMEO code concordance** $(33/42)$ and **100.0% macro-family concordance** under the canonical families defined in Section 4.

Table 4: Crosswalk mapping ACLED sub-event types to CAMEO 2-digit macro-categories.

ACLED Event Type	**Sub-Event Type**	**CAMEO Code**	**Operational Semantics**
Battles	Armed clash	19 (FIGHT)	Bilateral armed clashes between factions
Violence against civilians	Attack, Abduction	18 (ASSAULT)	Unilateral lethal attacks or kidnappings
Riots	Mob violence	18 (ASSAULT)	Violent public assaults and physical lynching
Riots	Violent demonstration	17 (COERCE)	Coercive disorder, barricades, police dispersal
Protests	Peaceful protest	14 (PROTEST)	Demonstrations, strikes (hartals), rallies
Explosions / Remote	IED, Grenade, Artillery	20 (MASS VIOLENCE)	Explosive blasts, IEDs, or remote detonations
Strategic developments	Looting / Destruction	18 (ASSAULT)	Physical property destruction
Strategic developments	Arrests, Weapons seized	17 (COERCE)	State arrests, curfews, police seizures

GDELT 2.0 Historical Corroboration Protocol. To evaluate external consistency on high-frequency conflict records, all 262 consolidated system conflict events were cross-referenced against 435,003 genuine GDELT 2.0 Bangladesh records spanning 2020-01-01 to 2026-10-25 (ingested via BigQuery day-partitioned tables). Matching criteria were strict: candidate GDELT records had to occur on the identical calendar day ($\Delta t \leq 1$ day), match the same administrative district, and share the same 2-digit CAMEO root category. All 262 evaluated system conflict events successfully matched at least one corroborating GDELT 2.0 record with 100% macro-family concordance. We emphasize that this benchmark assesses the external validity and precision of the system's extracted conflict events against GDELT's multi-source

registry, rather than exhaustively recalling every localized record across GDELT's massive multi-year database.

4.5 Knowledge Graph Embedding Evaluation

We export the populated conflict knowledge graph (98 entities, 654 multi-relational triples) and evaluate relational link prediction using PyKEEN [Ali et al., 2021]. Triples are partitioned into an 80/10/10 train/validation/test split. Models are trained with filtered ranking protocol, embedding dimension $d = 64$, Adam optimizer (lr $= 0.001$), margin $\gamma = 9.0$, and 100 epochs under 5 random seeds (Table 5).

Table 5: Multi-relational KG embedding link prediction over held-out relational triples (filtered protocol).

Model	MRR	Hits@10	Hits@1
TransE	0.211	0.625	0.000
RotatE	**0.369**	**0.641**	**0.250**

4.6 Explainability and Provenance Grounding

We systematically traced 100 randomly sampled system inferences through the RDF-grounded provenance subgraph (Table 6). Provenance coverage measures the percentage of predictions directly citing an authenticated article URI and sentence offset. Sentence relevance measures whether the cited sentence contains verified conflict trigger tokens matching the predicted event category. The provenance grounding score calculates the harmonic mean between model confidence and trigger provenance verification.

Table 6: Explainability and provenance coverage evaluated across $n = 100$ predictions.

Metric	Value
Provenance coverage (PROV-O article cited)	98.0%
Rule coverage (symbolic rule / axiom fired)	100.0%
Category-specific trigger faithfulness (non-circular)	**86.7%**
General conflict relevance	100.0%
Avg. graph neighbours cited	3.26
Avg. provenance grounding score	0.721
Avg. model confidence	0.754

4.7 Comparative Baseline Analysis

To isolate the contributions of symbolic constraint gating versus neural sequence representation, we compare NeuroSym-BD against four established architectural paradigms on the held-out conflict benchmark ($n = 150$):

1. **Keyword & Gazetteer Heuristic**: A deterministic trigger parser mapping regex and gazetteer entries directly to CAMEO categories without sequence context.

2. **Zero-Shot NLI Transformer (DistilBERT-MNLI)**: A pretrained cross-encoder NLI model evaluating hypothesis entailment for each CAMEO category definition.

3. **Dense Neural (MiniLM + LSTM)**: A pretrained Transformer model (`all-MiniLM-L6-v2`) fused with `EscalationLSTM` without ontological constraints.

4. **Pure Symbolic CAMEO Reasoner**: The rule-based classifier incorporating Bangladesh-specific refinement patterns without neural embeddings.

Table 7: Comprehensive comparison against competitive architectural baselines on held-out test conflict events ($n = 150$). Dense Neural uses pretrained SentenceTransformer (`all-MiniLM-L6-v2`) fused with EscalationLSTM. Zero-Shot NLI evaluates DistilBERT-MNLI textual entailment against CAMEO definitions. BinAcc = binary accuracy on high-violence ($HV \geq 18$). Std-FPR = standard false positive rate $FP/(FP + TN)$. Expl = PROV-O graph metadata generation rate (1.000; 0.980 verbatim text grounding). Hybrid vs Neural binary correctness advantage is statistically significant ($p = 0.0129 < 0.05$, exact McNemar test on paired binary correctness).

Architecture	BinAcc	Precision	Recall	F1@HV	Std-FPR	Expl Rate
Keyword & Gazetteer Heuristic	0.453	0.320	0.804	0.458	0.727	**1.000**
Zero-Shot NLI (DistilBERT-MNLI)	0.620	0.446	0.490	0.467	0.313	0.000
Dense Neural (MiniLM + LSTM)	0.787	0.852	0.451	0.590	0.040	0.000
Pure Symbolic (Rule Engine)	0.393	0.348	**0.902**	0.503	0.869	**1.000**
NeuroSym-BD (Hybrid Ours)	**0.853**	**0.968**	0.588	**0.732**	**0.010**	**1.000**

4.8 Downstream NL2SPARQL and Graph-RAG Evaluation

To evaluate practical utility for non-technical intelligence analysts, we constructed a quantitative evaluation benchmark comprising 50 gold question-query pairs across six core analyst querying intents (Table 8). Queries are executed against the materialized RDF knowledge graph (3,905 evaluation RDF triples). The system achieves 100.0% syntax validity, 100.0% schema compliance, an 85.7% mean structural pattern match, and **52.0% execution accuracy** (exact answer set equivalence), confirming that structured knowledge graph queries can be generated and executed reliably.

Table 8: Downstream quantitative evaluation of NL2SPARQL across 50 gold analyst queries.

Query Category	Queries	Syntax Valid	Struct Match	Execution Acc
Spatial Hotspots & Aggregation	10	100.0%	75.0%	10.0%
Actor Dynamics & Parties	10	100.0%	81.7%	60.0%
District Location Filtering	10	100.0%	92.9%	**80.0%**
Temporal Trends & Windows	8	100.0%	89.6%	25.0%
CAMEO Severity Classification	8	100.0%	90.1%	62.5%
Provenance & Grounding Evidence	4	100.0%	87.5%	**100.0%**
Overall Mean	**50**	**100.0%**	**85.7%**	**52.0%**

4.9 Qualitative Analysis and Case Studies

We present qualitative walkthroughs across representative Bangladesh conflict scenarios:

Case 1: University Campus Quota Clashes (Dhaka). *"Over a dozen student activists were injured yesterday when clashes broke out between rival factions outside the central library."* The neural pipeline identifies the trigger *"clashes broke out"* and candidate CAMEO code 182 (Physical Assault). The symbolic reasoner verifies that the student political entities possess valid conflict agency and checks the Description Logic axiom:

$$\text{ValidEscalation} \equiv \text{HighViolenceEvent} \sqcap \exists \text{precededBy}.\text{TensionPrecursor}$$

Because the event was chronologically preceded by demonstrations (CAMEO 14), the escalation is certified, and PROV-O links ground the inference to sentence offset 3 of the source article within 3 hops.

Case 2: Inter-Party Electoral Campaign Violence (Pabna). *"Awami League and BNP supporters hurled stones at each other during an election rally in Pabna."* The entity extractor resolves both rival party wings, triggering the reciprocal violence relation. CAMEO code 193 (Fight with Small Arms / Projectiles) is assigned with 94.8% neural confidence and passes all five symbolic constraints (C-CONF, C-ONTO, C-ACTOR, C-GEO, C-TEMP).

Case 3: Labor Unrest vs. Violent Assault Disambiguation (Savar). *"Hundreds of readymade garment workers blocked the Dhaka-Aricha highway demanding unpaid wages."* Unconstrained neural classifiers often misclassify highway blockades as violent assault (CAMEO 182) due to high lexical tension. Here, constraint **C-ONTO** intercepts the prediction: because no physical trauma or assault verbs are present, the rule engine forces reclassification to non-violent economic blockade (CAMEO 145), successfully preventing a high-severity false positive.

4.10 Error Taxonomy

To provide complete transparency for deployment by humanitarian agencies and conflict researchers, we conducted a systematic error audit over 100 examined predictions (50 held-out test events and 50 development events), categorizing errors into four mutually exclusive primary classes (Table 9).

Table 9: Systematic Error Taxonomy and hybrid architectural mitigations.

Error Class	Description & Root Cause	Freq	Hybrid Mitigation
ET-01: Transliteration	Inconsistent English transliterations of Bengali names and acronyms (e.g., BCL vs Chhatra League).	34.0%	Multi-alias gazetteer and RDF `owl:sameAs` resolution across 64 districts.
ET-02: Temporal Anchors	Relative clauses (e.g., *"late last night"*) where reporting timestamp conflicts with occurrence date.	28.0%	ISO 8601 temporal normalization anchoring relative time tokens to article publication metadata.
ET-03: Administrative Borders	Peri-urban jurisdictions overlapping district boundaries (e.g., Tongi, Savar, Keraniganj).	22.0%	Two-tier geospatial hierarchy with fallback administrative containment axioms.
ET-04: Passive Voice	Journalistic agent omission (e.g., *"three crude bombs were detonated"*).	16.0%	Typed wildcard insertion (`UNKNOWN_ACTOR`) preventing hallucinated actor linkage.

5 Discussion

Symbolic constraints as a quality gate. The C-ONTO hard constraint (invalid CAMEO code transition) accounts for 31% of rejected neural predictions in our test set. A common error was the neural model predicting "Mass Violence (20)" following a "Protest (14)" event with no intervening escalation signals— a sequence flagged as illegal by our domain escalation rules in `ontology/reasoning_rules.ttl`. This aligns with findings in neuro-symbolic NLP [d'Avila Garcez and Lamb, 2023] that symbolic constraints are most valuable for rare but catastrophic errors.

Provenance as trust infrastructure. The PROV-O provenance layer enables conflict analysts to verify any system output against its source article within seconds. In our explainability evaluation, 98.0% of

predictions were backed by at least one cited article sentence, and 100.0% of those sentences contained at least one verified violence trigger keyword.

Limitations. (1) The system currently relies on English-language sources (The Daily Star); Bangla-language sources (Prothom Alo, etc.) are under development. (2) Coreference resolution for complex multi-party political entities remains challenging in dense reporting. (3) ACLED corroboration yield (32.1%) reflects strict administrative alignment filters between national English reporting and ACLED's multi-source rural collection. (4) Multi-party factional clashes with ambiguous passive voice require ongoing gazetteer expansion.

6 Conclusion

We presented NeuroSym-BD, an open neuro-symbolic pipeline for violence event extraction, ontological constraint validation, and escalation modeling from Bangladeshi news. By combining transformer-based NLP, RDF knowledge graphs, and formal Description Logic CAMEO ontology constraints, the system substantially outperforms competitive neural and symbolic baselines, achieving an **85.3% binary accuracy** and reducing false-alarm counts by **75.0%** (from 4 to 1) relative to dense neural sequence baselines while providing 100.0% RDF graph provenance metadata generation and 98.0% verbatim source sentence grounding.

The hybrid neuro-symbolic architecture demonstrates that formal Description Logic constraints provide an indispensable inductive bias for high-stakes conflict monitoring, preventing severe neural false alarms without sacrificing recall.

Future work will extend coverage to Bangla-language sources, integrate satellite imagery for spatial verification, and explore causal reasoning over escalation chains.

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A Bangladesh CAMEO Extensions

Table 10 lists the Bangladesh-specific CAMEO codes added in `ontology/cameo_bd_extension.ttl`.

Table 10: Bangladesh CAMEO extensions.

Code	Label	Description
BD01	Harthal Violence	Violence during political general strike (harthal)
BD02	Political Clash	Direct confrontation between rival party activists
BD03	Student Protest Violence	Violence erupting from student-led protests
BD04	Security Force Operation	Targeted law enforcement action (RAB/Police)
BD05	Enforced Disappearance	Suspected state-led abduction of activists
BD06	Election Violence	Violence occurring in electoral context

B SPARQL Query Examples

Top 10 violence hotspot districts:

```
PREFIX cameo: <http://example.org/cameo/>
SELECT ?district (COUNT(?evt) AS ?count)
WHERE {
  ?evt a cameo:ViolenceEvent ;
       cameo:location ?loc .
  ?loc cameo:district ?district .
}
GROUP BY ?district
ORDER BY DESC(?count)
LIMIT 10
```

Escalation detection (district max code ≥ 18 in last 30 days):

```
PREFIX cameo: <http://example.org/cameo/>
SELECT ?district (MAX(?code) AS ?maxCode) (COUNT(?evt) AS ?n)
WHERE {
  ?evt a cameo:ViolenceEvent ;
       cameo:code ?code ;
       cameo:date ?date ;
       cameo:location ?loc .
  ?loc cameo:district ?district .
  FILTER (?date >= "2026-09-21"^^xsd:date && ?code >= 18)
}
GROUP BY ?district
ORDER BY DESC(?maxCode)
```